Holiday Gift Craft Cards

15 Christmas gifts kids can make, one card each: what you need and the quick steps

Print, cut along the dashed lines and keep the cards in your holiday craft bin. Pick a card, gather the supplies, and make a gift together.

Ages 2–12 | 15 gift crafts | Print, cut & keep

Gift Craft Cards

Each card has the ages, the time, the supplies and the steps from the article.

Salt Dough Ornaments

Ages 3–10 · 30 min + 3 hr bake

You need: 2 cups flour, 1 cup salt, 1 cup warm water, cookie cutters, acrylic paint, ribbon

1. Mix into a smooth dough
2. Cut shapes with cookie cutters
3. Poke a hole for the ribbon
4. Bake at 200°F (95°C) for 2–3 hours, flip halfway
5. Cool, then paint

Tip: A straw makes a perfectly round hanging hole.

Popsicle Stick Picture Frames

Ages 4–8 · 15 min

You need: popsicle sticks, glue, paint, sequins or 'jewels', a photo, tape, a magnet strip

1. Glue 4 sticks into a square (or layer 8)
2. Paint in festive colors
3. Add sequins or jewels
4. Tape a photo to the back
5. Add a magnet strip for the fridge

Tip: Perfect for relatives who live far away.

Pinecone Fire Starters

Ages 6–12 · 20 min · Adult help

You need: large pinecones, old candle scraps or beeswax, a double boiler, dried herbs or cinnamon

1. Collect and trim the pinecones
2. An adult melts the wax in a double boiler
3. Dip the pinecones (close supervision)
4. Sprinkle with herbs or cinnamon

Tip: Hot wax and lighting are adult jobs. Keep children at a safe distance.

Fingerprint Christmas Light Mugs

Ages 2–8 · 15 min + baking

You need: a plain white ceramic mug, black permanent marker, enamel paints

1. Draw a loopy 'string' around the mug
2. Dip a finger in paint
3. Press 'bulbs' along the string
4. Bake as the paint instructions say

Tip: Great for teachers and coffee-loving parents.

Bead and Pipe Cleaner Wreaths

Ages 3–6 · 10 min

You need: green pipe cleaners, red and green pony beads, red ribbon

1. Thread beads onto a pipe cleaner
2. Twist the ends into a circle
3. Add a small red bow on top

Tip: Small beads: supervise children who still put things in their mouths.

Scrabble Tile Ornaments

Ages 5–12 · 15 min

You need: wooden alphabet tiles, glue, ribbon or a thin wooden slat

1. Spell a name or a word like SNOW or MERRY
2. Glue the tiles onto ribbon or a slat
3. Add a loop for hanging

Tip: A favorite for teachers who love literacy.

Wood Slice Coasters

Ages 4–12 · 20 min

You need: wood slices, paint pens or permanent markers, clear sealant (like Mod Podge), baker's twine

1. Draw winter scenes or patterns
2. Let the ink dry
3. Add a coat of clear sealant
4. Tie a stack of four with twine

Tip: Lovely for new homeowners or the office.

Cinnamon Stick Trees

Ages 5–9 · 15 min

You need: cinnamon sticks, green ribbon or fabric scraps, a small star, glue, twine

1. Use the cinnamon stick as the trunk
2. Tie on ribbon: long at the bottom, short at the top
3. Glue a star on top
4. Add a twine loop for hanging

Tip: A great way to use up sewing scraps.

Mason Jar Hot Cocoa Mix

Ages 3–12 · 10 min

You need: a clean glass jar, cocoa powder, sugar, chocolate chips, mini marshmallows, stickers

1. Layer: cocoa, sugar, chocolate chips
2. Top with mini marshmallows
3. Decorate the jar with stickers or a tag

Tip: A sweet gift for neighbors and bus drivers.

Painted Rock Paperweights

Ages 3–10 · 20 min + drying

You need: smooth flat stones, acrylic paints, glossy varnish (optional)

1. Find stones on a nature walk
2. Wash and dry them
3. Paint snowmen, penguins or patterns
4. Add glossy varnish when dry

Tip: Made for a parent's or grandparent's desk.

Hand-Drawn Ribbon Bookmarks

Ages 4–10 · 10 min

You need: wide light-colored ribbon, fabric markers, a small charm or bead, glue

1. Cut the ribbon into 8-inch strips
2. Draw holiday scenes with fabric markers
3. Glue a charm or bead to the end

Tip: Lightweight and easy to mail.

Tissue Paper Decoupage Votives

Ages 2–6 · 20 min

You need: small glass jars, red and green tissue paper, half glue / half water (or Mod Podge), battery tea lights

1. Tear the tissue paper into small bits
2. Brush the glue mix onto the jar
3. Stick the paper on
4. Let dry, then add a battery tea light

Tip: Use battery tea lights, not candles.

Birdseed Ornaments

Ages 4–10 · 15 min + overnight

You need: 2 cups birdseed, 1 packet unflavored gelatin, 1/2 cup water, cookie cutters

1. Dissolve the gelatin in the water
2. Mix in the birdseed
3. Press into cookie cutters
4. Let dry overnight

Tip: Bird watchers and grandparents love these.

Pom-Pom Gnomes

Ages 6–12 · 20 min

You need: large white pom-poms, small wooden beads, felt, glue

1. Use a pom-pom for the beard
2. Add a wooden bead nose
3. Roll a felt triangle into a cone hat
4. Glue it all together

Tip: Make a whole gnome family as a set.

Handprint Reindeer Dish Towels

Ages 2–8 · 15 min + drying

You need: plain white flour sack towels, brown fabric paint, fabric marker, a tiny red pom-pom

1. Press painted hands on the towel as antlers
2. Let the paint dry
3. Draw a face with fabric marker
4. Glue on a red pom-pom nose

Tip: A keepsake that comes out every December.

Before you start: Look for paints, markers and glue with the ACMI AP (Approved Product) seal, and write your child's name and the year on the back of every gift.

Gift Tags for Your Handmade Gifts

Cut out a tag, let your child fill it in, and tie it on with ribbon or twine.

Merry Christmas!
- To: _____
- From: _____

Made with Love
- To: _____
- From: _____

Happy Holidays!
- To: _____
- From: _____

Handmade by Me
- To: _____
- Made by: _____

Season's Greetings
- To: _____
- From: _____

Merry & Bright
- To: _____
- From: _____

Merry Christmas!
- To: _____
- From: _____

Made with Love
- To: _____
- From: _____

Happy Holidays!
- To: _____
- From: _____

From “15 Easy Christmas Crafts for Kids That Even Busy Parents Can Manage” on nestoodle.com/christmas-crafts-for-kids. More free printables at nestoodle.com.